SWYPEJOBS · CAREER OFFICE PRODUCT BRIEF

Gaps versus Handshake's career office

Handshake's staff product is an operations desk. Ours is an insights shell with a thin ops layer. Advisors open Handshake to clear queues. They open ours to read a board pack.

Internal design comparison · 3 November 2026 · Sources: Handshake Help Center (job/employer approvals, staff roles, reporting) and Handshake 2025 EDU vision. Our side: current `/campus` routes.

Inbox first
Handshake daily start

Dashboard first
Our Campus Home

10 staff jobs
Compared in this brief

1 unique win
Swipe demand signals

Mental model

Handshake organizes around queues: pending jobs, pending employers, today's appointments, upcoming fairs. We organize around reports: placement rate, engagement, equity flag. Advisors come in to process work, not to read a board pack. Home should be the queue; Reports should be the board pack.

Staff jobs

STAFF JOB	HANDSHAKE	THIS PRODUCT	CALL
Morning inbox	Pending jobs first. Approving a job can approve the employer. Auto-approve by industry, title, employer type.	Home is a KPI dashboard. Approvals is a separate list. The same Approve/Hold also lives under Actions.	Handshake leads
Employer relations	Employer CRM: search, notes, flags, roles at the school, default permissions, heatmaps.	Invite form + partnership request list. One employer is not a durable relationship record with history.	Handshake leads
Curate student feed	Collections of jobs, employers, events, and fairs. Students follow collections and filter search by them.	Job-only collections that power the Campus curated Discover stack. Stronger default for swipe, narrower object model.	Different edge
Advise students	Appointment types, mediums, rooms, drop-ins, counselor calendars, notes, staff-level permissions.	Student requests a datetime. Staff Confirm / Complete / No-show / Cancel. No calendar, rooms, or counselor identity.	Handshake leads
Events and fairs	Events + career fairs as products: booths, registration, QR check-in, invoices, attendee email.	Title, type, start time. Student RSVP is Going / not. Fair booths are not built.	Handshake leads
On-campus recruiting	Interview schedules, slot assignment, room check-in.	Interviews live in recruiter–student chat, not a campus-owned schedule.	Handshake leads

STAFF JOB	HANDSHAKE	THIS PRODUCT	CALL
Student outreach	Student search, targeted email, collections follow, event targeting.	Nudge form on a named attention list (seniors / quiet / zero). No student directory or campaign history.	Started
Reporting	Insights: dashboards, 50+ prebuilt reports, scheduled email, custom reports, Access vs Manage.	Eight report pages that repeat the KPI grid. NACE/HEC export exists.	Coverage, not a tool
Staff roles	Access vs Manage per module (jobs, employers, events, appointments, analytics, fairs).	director / advisor / dean is labeled in the header. Nav and actions are the same for everyone.	Handshake leads
Demand signal	Applications, profile views, fair check-ins, employer heatmaps.	Swipe right vs pass by category, want-vs-posted. Handshake cannot see this. Unique.	We lead

Flow, not features

Handshake daily loop

1. Open pending jobs. Approve, decline, or request more info. Auto-rules eat the obvious ones.
2. Scan today's appointments and drop-ins. Notes stay on the student.
3. Check fair / event registrations and employer booth questions.
4. Pull a student list or employer record only when doing outreach.
5. Insights is a separate mode for the director and institutional reporting.

Our daily loop today

1. Land on six KPIs and source badges. Primary CTA is "Open action queue."
2. Approvals is a title + company row with Approve / Hold. No job body, no "request info," no auto-approve.
3. Employers is invite + pending partnership. No notes, flags, or school-level roles.
4. Advising is a flat request list. Events is a three-field form.
5. Actions duplicates approvals, events, and nudges. Reports splits the same snapshot across eight URLs.

Information architecture

Handshake (simplified)

Students · Employers · Jobs · Events · Fairs · Appointments · Interviews · Insights · Settings

Objects first. Permissions (Access / Manage) hide write actions. Settings is a real product: approval preferences, appointment types, rooms.

Ours (current)

Home · Approvals · Curated jobs · Employers · Advising · More (4) · Reports (8)

Primary set is the right instinct. Reports still has eight peers that are one dashboard with different charts. Actions is a junk drawer. staffRole is cosmetic.

Where we should not copy Handshake

Handshake's student surface is search. Ours is swipe. Campus curated as the default Discover stack is the correct career-office lever — one collection membership changes what students see first. Handshake collections are optional filters on a search product.

Swipe right vs pass by category is a demand signal Handshake does not have. Keep it on Home as an operations insight ("students want X, we have Y jobs"), not as another report page.

Do not recreate Handshake's 50-report catalog. One Insights mode with saved exports (NACE / HEC) is enough until a director asks for scheduled email.

Close the gap in this order

PRIORITY	CHANGE	WHY IT MATCHES STAFF REALITY
P0	Make Home an inbox: pending jobs, pending employers, today's advising, students needing a nudge.	Advisors process queues. Directors can still open Reports.
P0	Job-based approval like Handshake: one queue, job body visible, approve-job-approves-employer, Hold with a reason.	Stops Approvals and Actions from being two copies of the same decision.
P1	Employer record: notes, status history, invite + partnership on one profile. Kill the three stacked lists.	Employer relations is a CRM job, not a form job.
P1	Advising calendar: staff identity, type, confirm/reschedule. Student already books; the desk is the hole.	This is the actual in-office work Handshake owns.
P2	Events with RSVP counts and a student list. Fairs/booths later.	A datetime form is not an event product.
P2	Collapse eight report routes into Insights. Keep NACE export. Staff roles that actually hide write actions.	Matches Handshake's Access vs Manage without copying their report zoo.

Design tradeoff

Copying Handshake's full career-center suite is a multi-year product. Winning as a campus tool means being better at the two things they are weak at (swipe curation + demand from passes) and being competent at the three things staff will not switch without (job queue, employer record, advising desk).

Appendix · Product UI gaps already in this codebase

Separate from Handshake. These are visual and IA issues on the Next.js app itself.

GAP	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Two visual languages	Discover, Chat, Feed, Insights feel designed. Events, Mentorship, Partnerships, Help, and most Campus tools still read as spec CRUD.
Overloaded chrome	Student top nav, bottom nav, and More disagree on labels. Campus previously exposed 16 peer items; now primary + More/Reports — Reports still has eight destinations.
Dead header API	Eyebrow is now rendered on the shared page header. Spec pages still need to stay on that header as new screens land.
Token pile	Clearpath, Apple, waitlist, and monochrome names still sit in CSS. Dark tokens exist; `.dark` is not wired.